

मैं और मेरे बीच की दूरी

The longest distance in existence
is not between places,
but between
me and myself.

UTKARSH

THIS IS MY SECOND BOOK

मैं और मेरे बीच की दूरी

The Distance Between Me and Myself

THIS IS MY SECOND BOOK

My first book, *The Emptiness We Share*, was published on Amazon and marked the beginning of a journey that I did not fully understand at the time. Looking back, I realize that every page I wrote was leading me here—to this question, this search, this distance.

I did not write this book because I found the answers.

I wrote it because the questions refused to leave.

I am a first-year Biotechnology student. By day, I study genes, proteins, cells, and the intricate architecture of life. Science reveals how organisms evolve, how neurons communicate, and how consciousness emerges from matter.

Yet every night, another universe opens. A universe where equations cannot explain longing, where data cannot measure wonder, and where the deepest questions remain untouched by certainty.

If we are merely collections of atoms, why do we spend our lives searching for meaning? If consciousness is a product of biology, why does it yearn for something beyond itself? And if we understand so much about the world, why do we understand so little about the one who experiences it?

This book was born between microscopes and midnight thoughts. Between knowledge and mystery. Between what can be proven and what can only be felt.

It is not a book of conclusions. It is a book of encounters.

> With love.
> With suffering.
> With memory.
> With death.
> With time.
> And above all, with the stranger hidden behind the word "I."

For years, humanity has searched the heavens for answers. We have mapped the stars, split the atom, decoded the genome, and measured the age of the universe.

Yet perhaps the greatest mystery has never been out there.

> *Perhaps it has always been here—*
> *behind our thoughts,*
> *beneath our identities,*
> *waiting in the silence we spend our lives trying to escape.*

Perhaps the longest distance in existence is not between galaxies.

> *It is the distance between who we are,*
> *and who we believe ourselves to be.*
> *Between the self we show the world,*
> *and the self that watches from within.*
> *Between me,*
> *and myself.*

This book is an attempt to walk that distance.

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देह कहे मैं जीव हूँ, मन कहे पहचान।
मौन खड़ा जो देखता, उसका क्या विधान॥

Beyond body and mind is the mystery of awareness itself.

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ब्रह्मांडों की भीड़ में, धरती एक सराय।
फिर भी मानव लड़ रहा, 'मेरा-तेरा' गाए॥

Against the scale of the cosmos, many human conflicts appear strangely small.

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जन्म लिया ब्रह्मांड ने, पूछे कौन गवाह।
देखने वाला जन्म से पहले, बैठा था किस राह॥

Before asking how the universe began, ask: What is this awareness that can even ask the question? That mystery may be deeper than the Big Bang itself.

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मछली पूछे सागर कहाँ, पंछी पूछे गगन।
खोजत-खोजत मर गया, जिसमें था जीवन॥

The seeker is often searching for what it has never been separate from.

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तारे जन्मे, तारे बुझे, ब्रह्मांड हुए राख।
फिर भी बैठा मौन कुछ, जिसके नहीं पराख॥

Even if universes come and go, there may be something beyond all change.

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जिसको कहते 'मैं' यहाँ, हर पल बदले रूप।
बदल न पाए जो कभी, उसका कौन स्वरूप॥

Everything you call yourself changes continuously. What, then, is the constant observer?

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समय नहीं बहता कहीं, बहता केवल ध्यान।
घड़ी पकड़ संसार को, खो बैठा वर्तमान॥

Perhaps time is not moving; perhaps awareness is.

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ईश्वर भी इक नाम है, शून्य भी इक बोल।
जो दोनों से बच गया, उसका कौन उसूल॥

Every concept, even "God" and "Void," may still be a mental construction.

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देह धरे तो जीव है, देह गिरे तो शोक।
बादल बदले रूप को, आकाशे किस रोक॥

We mourn forms while overlooking the continuity beneath them.

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जितना गहरा देखता, उतना जग अंजान।
ज्ञान शिखर पर जा मिला, अपने ही अज्ञान॥

Ultimate wisdom may be the recognition of irreducible mystery.

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श्वास नहीं तू, देह नहीं तू, न स्मृति, न विचार।
फिर भी कुछ है जो कहे—'मैं हूँ' बारंबार॥

The deepest mystery is not existence, but the feeling of being.

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प्रेम किया तो जान ले, खोना उसका धर्म।
जो नश्वर से प्रेम करे, वही समझे मर्म॥

The pain of loss is not the failure of love; it is proof that love touched reality.

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यदि मैं सचमुच जन्मा हूँ, जन्म से पहले कौन।
यदि मैं कभी न जन्मा था, फिर यह जग क्यों मौन॥

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सागर लहरों से भरा, लहर न जाने बात।
मानव वैसा ही खड़ा, पूछे अपनी जात॥

We search for our place in existence while already being expressions of it.

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जिस दिन 'मैं' सच मर गया, कुछ भी नहीं मरा।
तब जाना जीवन सदा, बस रूपों में फिरा॥

Perhaps what dies is only the story. What remains may never have been born.

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दुख से इतना प्रेम है, सुख का करता शोर।
घाव न छूटे हाथ से, माँगे मरहम और॥

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क्षमा नहीं उपकार है, न कोई ऊँचा धर्म।
विष पीकर जो बच गया, वही समझे मर्म॥

Forgiveness frees the one carrying the poison.

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भीतर जितना शून्य है, उतना बाहर शोर।
खाली घर की गूँज को, समझे जग हुंकार॥

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